



Ink left or not?

Are we throwing away printer cartridges without completely using them?

<http://dgit.in/WasteInk>



Cortana on Cyanogen

Now Cyanogen wants to integrate Cortana into its OS.

<http://dgit.in/MicroCyano>



Security scrutiny with Symantec

Digit speaks to Gavin Lowth, Vice President, Norton Consumer & Small Business, Asia Pacific and Japan about car hacks, whether free AV software is good enough, security concerns on wearables and more.

◀ Gavin Lowth, Vice President, Norton Consumer & Small Business, Asia Pacific and Japan

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So what's new at Symantec?

Gavin: So with Mike Brown being in the CEO position, he has made some big calls around the future course of Symantec as an organisation. One his first decisions when he came in as CEO was he split the Norton business into its own business unit. That's been massively different for us in terms of employees working in the Norton Business Unit, our partners, and our customers as well. We're trying to become very clear in terms of how we communicate to them for our protection technologies.

We used to also do large scale anti-virus tests a long time ago. We'd use virus database samples from VirusSign, we had a Linux guy who'd do real time penetration using Kali, but the antivirus companies were always unhappy, saying a particular anti-virus database could be biased towards one particular AV. Now we only do a comparison based on features. Your thoughts?

Gavin: Look, we still use file based signatures but it's just a tiny part of our protection technologies. That's where we've come from because that's how we used to do it, that's how the industry started, but you know we have award winning intrusion prevention system technologies. If we

look at the AV security industry today, as I said signature base is a very small part. RPS gets to a next level. But this, what we call reputation based is huge for us. Because of the scale, because Norton is so big, we see things quicker. So you talk about your zero day attacks, with a reputation and heuristics based technology that we have, we are the first to see threats. With the amount of data that we have, we see in seconds what our competitors see in a week. We very rapidly are updating the security technologies. The latest product we have shifted a lot of protection technologies into the cloud, so we can get it down to the consumer devices, whether it be android or PCs, very very quickly. The amount of work they have put in, over the last 18 months (whilst we have been quiet externally) they've spending a lot of time, and a lot of effort in upgrading the protection technology. The feedback is super positive.

I'm guessing the multi-device license strategy is working out well in this market?

Gavin: Very, very well. The awareness around PC security, is very high. Three or four years ago, as mobiles started to proliferate, the awareness was still very low on mobiles. And what's starting to happen now, as people start to realise the amount of data, and the value of information on a ₹3000 or a ₹10,000 phone, is becoming

more and more relevant. So people are understanding how to protect the phone itself by installing top products. The multi device, as I said, we were the first to use it, and it's worked out very well, people who used to typically have a PC, would start to use the same licence, or the same access of same licence into their Android phones and other platforms. So it's worked well for us and we are starting to see a big uptake as the awareness increases.

You spoke about positioning Norton not just as an antivirus company, what does that mean exactly?

Gavin: If you look at any antivirus technology, even the technologies around the Norton security product today, as I see it, the antivirus piece is less than 20% of the technology pie. You've got a two way firewall, intrusion prevention systems, this reputation based scanning which is very quick, that can see the behavior of certain files. This can actually warn you very quickly and say, "Hey! This looks like a threat. It smells like a bad threat, it's behaving like a bad threat. It's most probably a bad threat." Even without the signature to match. It takes years and years and scale to build that sort of reputation, that sort of database.

So as far as the PC version is concerned, the kind of the feedback that we get from our